

Squad Goals: Designing a Friendly and Safe Way to Save Together

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*This case study was created as part of a course project to demonstrate UX/UI design skills. The research and findings are based on hypothetical scenarios and user interviews conducted for learning purposes using ChatGPT.

Project overview



The product:

An app designed to help friends and family groups manage household budgets and save towards a shared financial goal, such as a vacation or an emergency fund. The app simplifies expense tracking, contributions, and goal visualization.



Project duration:

02/2025 - 03/2025



Project overview



The problem:

Managing shared expenses and savings within a group is often disorganized, leading to confusion, missed payments, and financial stress. Existing solutions lack an intuitive, collaborative approach for multiple users.



The goal:

- Facilitate transparent group financial management.
- Enable seamless goal-setting and progress tracking.
- Ensure an intuitive and accessible user experience.
- Provide insights and automated suggestions for better saving habits.

Project overview



My role:

UX/UI Designer.



Responsibilities:

- Conducted user research.
- Designed wireframes, prototypes, and high-fidelity mockups.
- Developed responsive front-end components.
- Conducted usability tests and iterated designs.
- Ensured accessibility and inclusivity.

Understanding the user

- User research
- Personas
- Problem statements

User research: Summary



For this project, I conducted 5 interviews with participants who actively manage shared expenses. Initially, I assumed that most users would prefer automated financial tracking, but the research revealed that they value manual control with optional automation. I also discovered that transparency in contributions was a top priority, as users wanted clear visual indicators of progress and accountability within their group.

User research: pain points

1

Lack of transparency

Users have a hard time visualizing who has contributed and how far away the goal is.

2

Disorganization on payments

There's not a clear method to register payments, which leads to misunderstandings and delays.

Some users forget to contribute on time which affects financial group planning.

3

Complexity in Tracking Shared Expenses

The lack of clear categorization of expenses makes group budget management difficult.

4

Lack of Motivation to Save

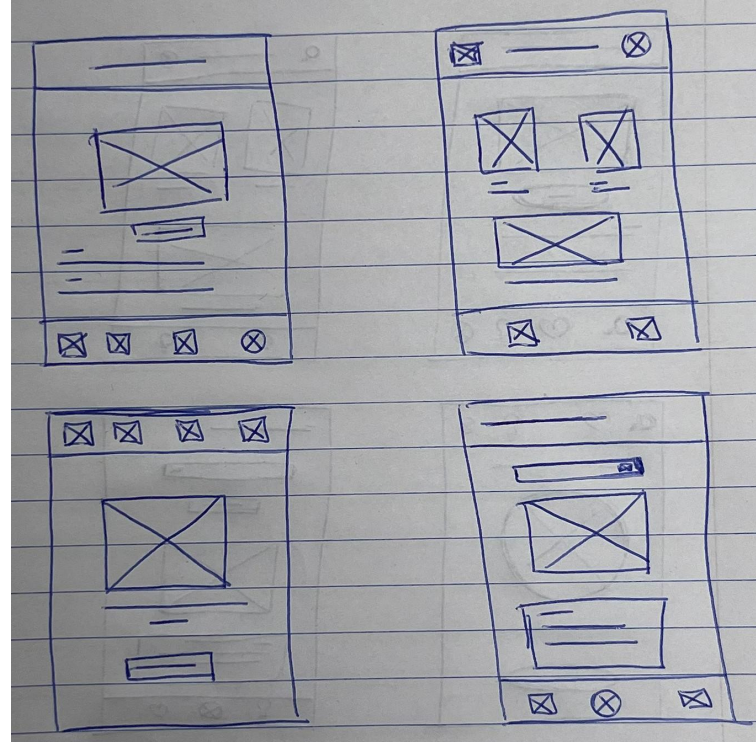
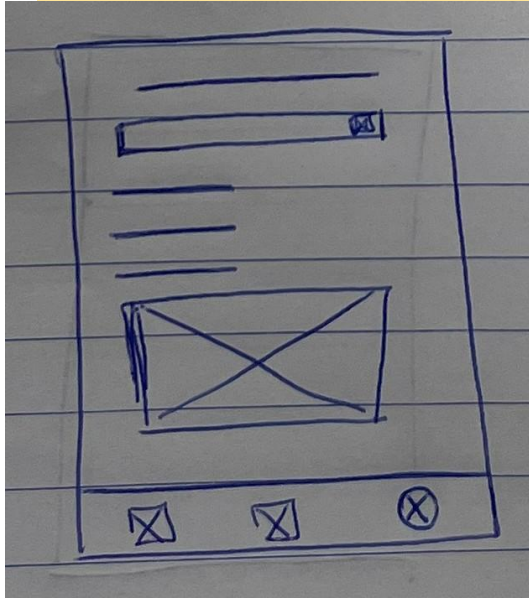
Without incentives or reminders, some users lose the habit of contributing regularly.

Persona: **Maria**

Problem statement:

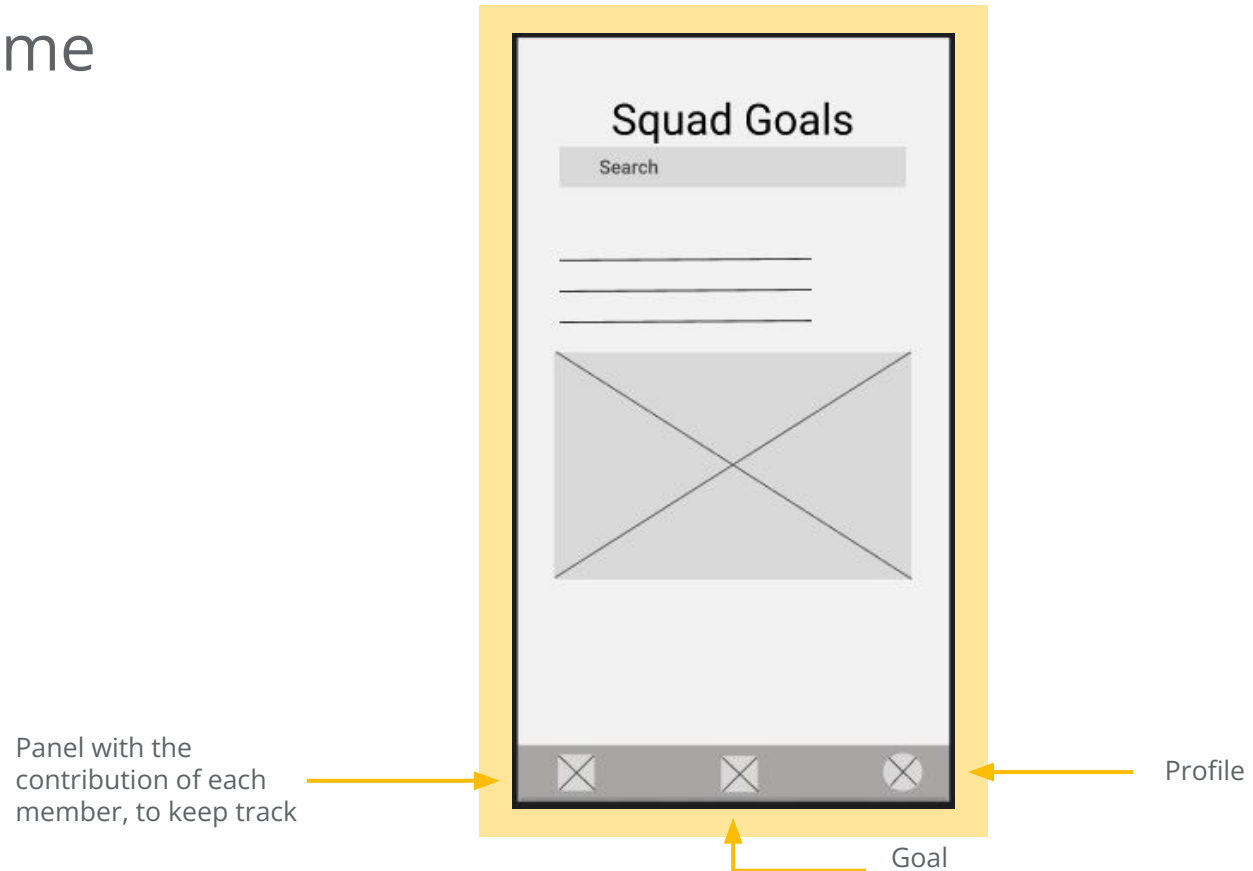
Maria is an administrative assistant who needs a simple and secure way to contribute to a shared savings goal because she finds it difficult to stay motivated and organized when saving alone, and prefers the accountability and support of a group.

Paper wireframes



Digital wireframe

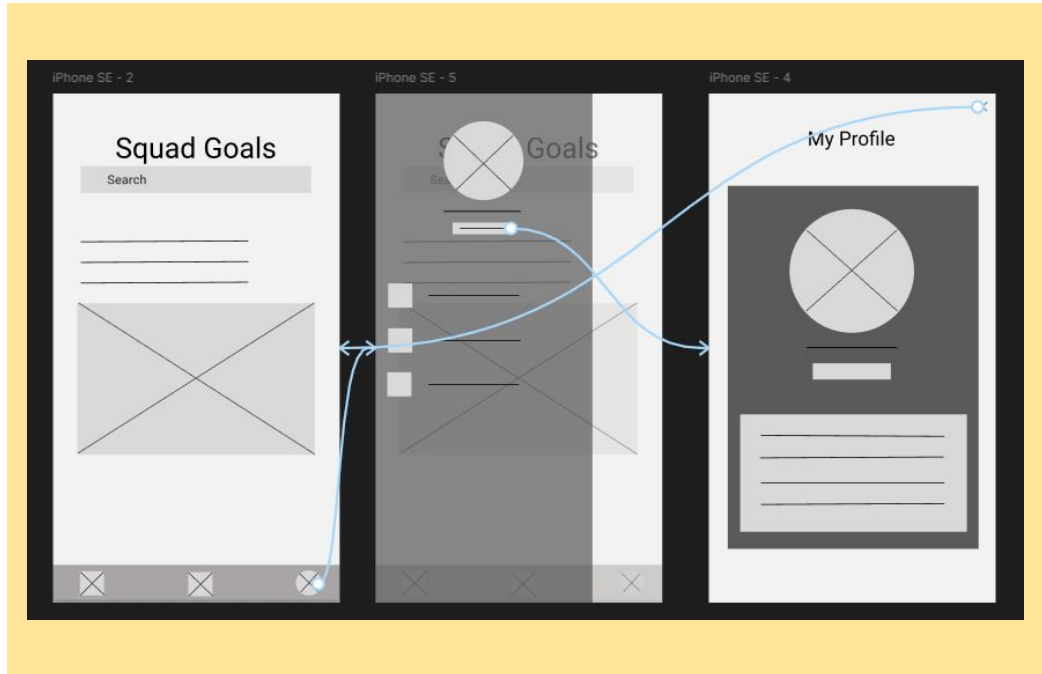
Main screen



Low-fidelity prototype

Link to prototype

<https://www.figma.com/proto/t2e9zdJNSJpq3gj7l6eiRA/Squad-Goals-App?node-id=4-3655&p=f&t=B4pTznQbvVa1Q7zR-1&scaling=scale-down&content-scaling=fixed&page-id=0%3A1>



Simulation of Usability study

5 participants in total.

3 users with basic experience using financial apps.

2 users with no prior experience with group savings apps.

Tasks they were asked to complete:

- Access your profile from the home screen.
- Search for an existing savings goal.
- View details for a specific goal.

Findings

1

Problem: Undescriptive icons in the bottom navigation

Note: Some users didn't understand what the circular icon with an X represents (probably accessing the menu or profile).

2

Problem: The side menu has low contrast

Note: The gray background of the slide menu has low contrast and may make it difficult to read or interact with for users with low vision.

3

Problem: It's not clear whether certain elements can be touched.

Note: On the main screen, objectives have no visual indicators that they are interactive elements.

4

Problem: Flowing to the profile requires two taps

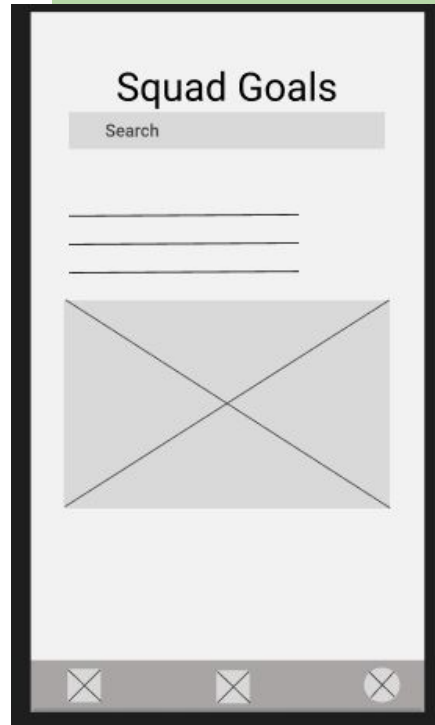
Note: Some users expected that tapping their avatar directly in the bar would take them to the profile, but it appears to open a menu first.

Refining the design

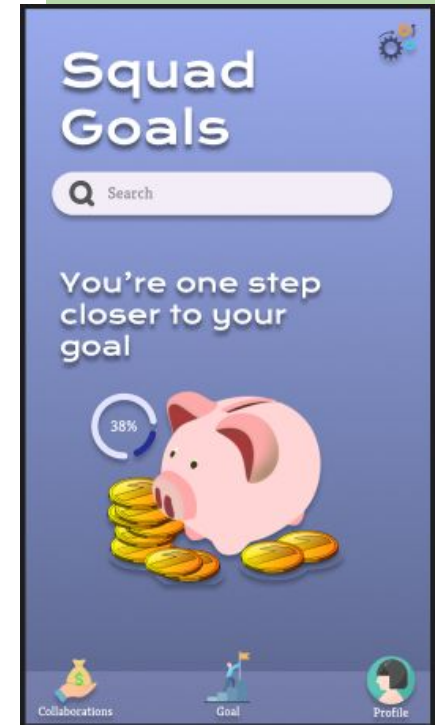
- Mockups
- High-fidelity prototype
- Accessibility

Mockups

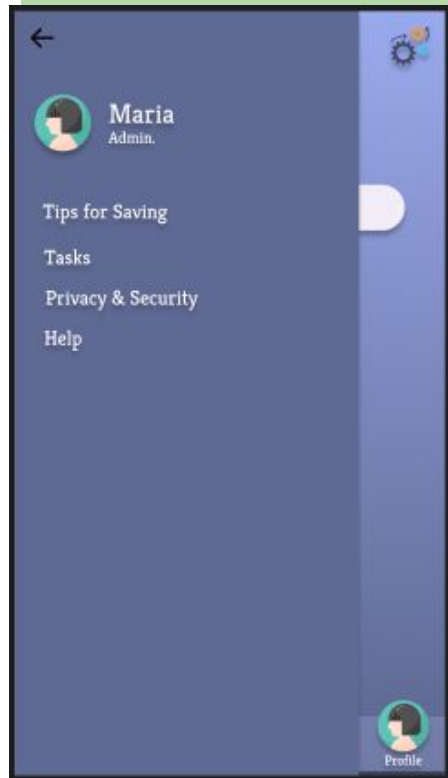
Before usability study



After usability study



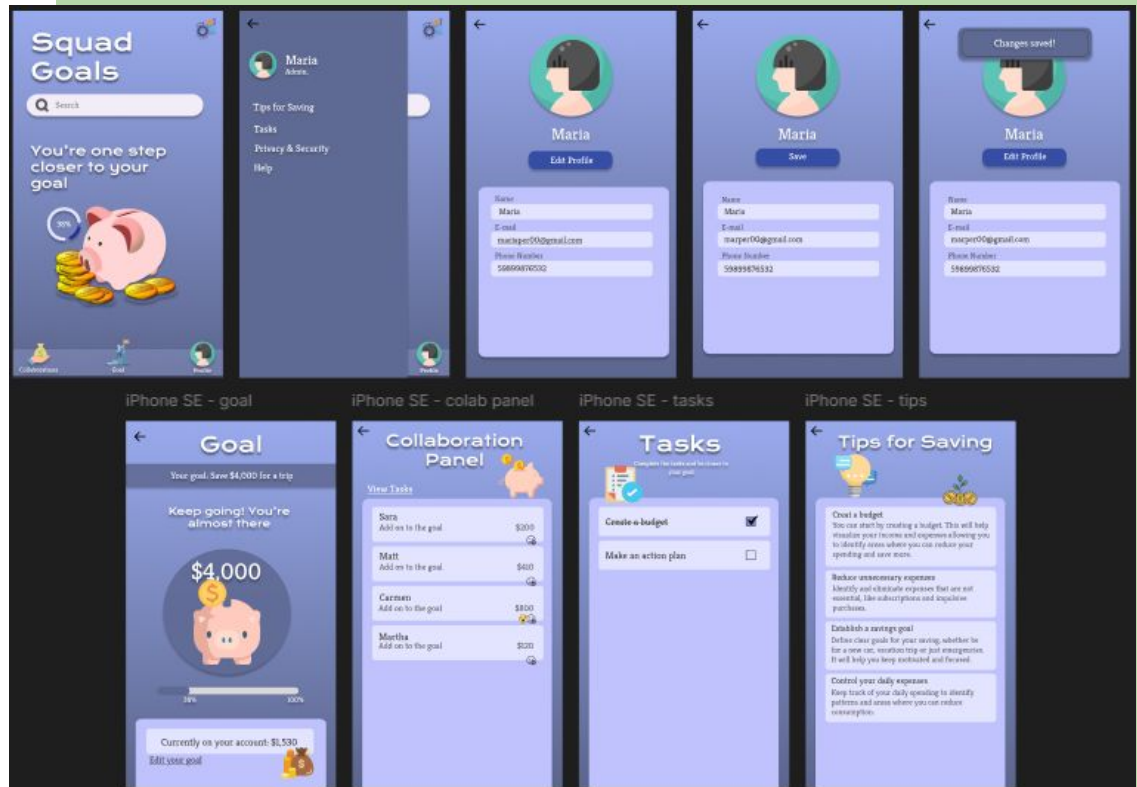
Mockups



High-fidelity prototype

Link to prototype:

<https://www.figma.com/proto/t2e9zdINSIpg3gi7l6eiRA/Squad-Goals-App?node-id=46-216&p=f&t=Qn9r6Giyr3TtGgHE-0&scaling=min-zoom&content-scaling=fixed&page-id=14%3A32&starting-point-node-id=46%3A216>



Accessibility considerations

1

Used high-contrast color schemes and readable typography.

2

Included screen reader-friendly labels and alt text for visual elements.

Going forward

- Takeaways
- Next steps

Takeaways



Impact:

- Increased user confidence in group financial management.
- Simplified the saving process, reducing conflicts over shared expenses.



What I learned:

- Importance of clear visual hierarchy and accessibility.
- Users appreciate automation but still want manual controls.

Next steps

1

Expand usability testing with a larger audience.

A broader and more diverse group of users will validate the user experience in different contexts and continue to iterate on the design to ensure inclusiveness.

2

Add integrations with banking APIs for seamless transactions

Connect the app to banking APIs to allow users to link their accounts and make transfers directly from the platform. This would make the joint savings process more agile, reliable and automated.

3

Implement AI-driven financial recommendations.

Incorporate AI-powered features to offer personalized recommendations based on users' spending and saving habits.

Let's connect!



Feel free to reach out or take a look at my GitHub. I'm always excited to connect and take on new challenges!

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